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Do startups still need
Silicon Valley? Hear from
the founders and funders
challenging old
assumptions at
TechCrunch Disrupt 2025



TechCrunch Events — 7:30 AM PDT · July 28, 2025

As the startup world descends on San Francisco for [TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#) — happening October 27-29 at Moscone West — one question looms large: Does building in Silicon Valley still give founders an edge? With 10,000+ startup and VC leaders gathering for this milestone Disrupt, the conversation around access, geography, and opportunity has never been more timely.

On the [Builders Stage](#), Anh-Tho Chuong (Lago), David Hall (Revolution), and Heather Doshay (SignalFire) lead a must-attend session for anyone looking to scale smart in today's startup landscape.

IMAGE CREDITS:

PHOTO BY BARAK SHRAMA/SLAVA BLAZER

PHOTOGRAPHY

[Register now to save up to \\$675](#) before July ends and to join this (and many more sessions).

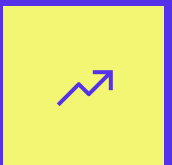
DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

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Why this conversation matters now

As distributed teams, regional hubs, and global fundraising become more normalized, founders are increasingly asking if their ZIP code actually gives them an edge. Does being in the Bay Area still open the right doors? Or has the playing field finally leveled?

This [session](#) brings together startup veterans and seasoned investors who've built and backed companies across the country — and well beyond it. They'll dig into what access looks like in 2025, how remote collaboration has evolved post-pandemic, and where true opportunity lies for emerging founders.

Who's taking the Builders Stage for this session

[Anh-Tho Chuong](#) is rethinking open source billing with [Lago](#), a YC-backed platform trusted by AI leaders like Mistral and Together. From her time scaling Qonto to her early roles at Weebly and McKinsey, she's no stranger to navigating growth across continents.

[David Hall](#) has spent the last decade proving that game-changing companies don't have to come out of Silicon Valley. As managing partner at [Revolution](#)'s Rise of the Rest Seed Fund, he's helped build a portfolio that spans the country — backing bold founders in places often overlooked by coastal VCs.

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Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and

sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

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[Heather Doshay](#) knows how to scale people-first organizations from the inside. As a partner at [SignalFire](#) and former VP of People at Webflow, she's seen how the hiring landscape has shifted for startups outside the Valley — and what it takes to build standout teams in a distributed world.

Join the debate at Disrupt

Whether you're building from a big city, a small town, or somewhere in between, this session will offer a fresh perspective on where startup success really comes from. Find out what still matters, what doesn't, and how to build your network — no matter your location.

Catch this panel live on the [Builders Stage](#) at Disrupt 2025, happening October 27-29 at Moscone West in San Francisco. Tickets are moving fast, and prices increase after July — [register now to save up to \\$675](#) and lock in your spot.



IMAGE CREDITS:KIMBERLY WHITE / GETTY IMAGES

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Term sheets, traction, and truth bombs: Inside the Series A mindset at TechCrunch Disrupt 2025

TechCrunch Events — 7:30 AM PDT · August 1, 2025

[TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#) taking place October 27-29 at Moscone West in San Francisco, we're getting real about what it takes to land a Series A in today's market — no smoke, no mirrors, just the unfiltered perspective from the people signing the checks.

IMAGE CREDITS:

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Series A has changed — here's how to win in 2026

This [Builder Stage session](#) brings together three power players in early-stage investing: Katie

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Every weekday and Sunday, you can get the best of TechCrunch's coverage.

Stanton ([Moxxie Ventures](#)), Thomas Krane ([Insight Partners](#)), and Sangeen Zeb ([GV](#)). They’ve seen thousands of decks, led major rounds, and helped steer startups from scrappy beginnings to breakout scale.

This conversation goes deeper than the headlines. From the metrics that matter and how to tell your growth story, to what causes investors to walk away — you’ll hear what actually moves a pitch from “maybe” to “we’re in.”

Meet the VCs who know how to spot a rocket ship

[Katie Stanton](#) brings a track record most operators only dream of. From Twitter and the Obama White House to backing more than 100 early-stage companies like [Airtable](#), [Calm](#), and [Carta](#), she’s built Moxxie Ventures on conviction and founder-first instincts.

[Thomas Krane](#) has spent over a decade at [Insight Partners](#), climbing from analyst to managing director while backing some of the biggest names in software and cybersecurity. With IPO wins like [JFrog](#) and [SentinelOne](#), he knows what scalable traction looks like — and how to fund it.

[Sangeen Zeb](#) is a general partner at [GV](#) with an eye for enterprise and AI. His board work spans companies like [Vercel](#) and [Harvey](#), and he’s helped lead investments in some of the most talked-about growth stories in tech.

Your Series A isn’t just a round — it’s a reset

The market is tighter, the stakes are higher, and this is the session founders can’t afford to miss. Learn

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what it takes to raise on your terms and build for the long game. Lock in your [seat at TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#) now to save up to \$675 and join 10,000+ startup and VC leaders in the room where deals — and futures — get made.



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

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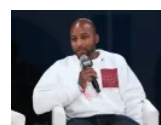


Get inside Disrupt: Volunteer at TechCrunch Disrupt 2025

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How to actually raise a seed round:
Actionable advice from top investors
at TechCrunch Disrupt 2025

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- 13 hours ago

from the best

You'll do more than just lend a hand. As a volunteer, you'll get a behind-the-scenes look at the production of a high-energy tech event packed with big names, breakout startups, and some of the sharpest minds in AI, VC, and beyond. And yes — you'll also earn your own **free General Admission pass** (worth up to \$1,500) to attend the full conference.

What you'll do

From keeping check-in lines moving to helping founders find their booth space, you'll support the event in all the ways that make it run smoothly — and keep the energy high. Volunteer tasks may include:

- Assisting with registration.
- Crowd and line management.
- Directional and customer support.
- Helping with expo setup.
- General event logistics and support.

What you'll get

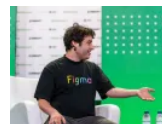
✓ Full access to Disrupt

After completing your volunteer shift, enjoy three days of full conference access, including sessions, networking, and startup showcases.

✓ Real-world experience

See firsthand how top-tier tech events come together, and connect with professionals across

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Figma's IPO success is 'a little bit of a meme stock,' says Sapphire Ventures' Jai Das

Rebecca Bellan,
Theresa Loconsolo
- 15 hours ago

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Payment platform Lava raises \$5.8M to build digital wallets for the 'agent-native economy'

Dominic-Madori Davis
- 16 hours ago

the startup and VC world.



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✓ Massive networking potential

Meet 10,000+ startup and VC leaders, join Braindate sessions, and plug into hundreds of side events happening around the city.

What we need from you

- A minimum of 10 hours of volunteer time during the event
- Attendance at a mandatory orientation on **Sunday, October 26**, at Moscone West
- Age 18+
- San Francisco/Bay Area locals preferred (but not required)

Ready to volunteer?

We're now accepting volunteer applications for TechCrunch Disrupt 2025. Get involved, get inspired, and get your foot in the door — [apply to volunteer](#) at Disrupt today.

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Crack the code to startup traction with insights from Chef Robotics, NEA, and ICONIQ at TechCrunch Disrupt 2025

Finding product-market fit isn't a milestone — it's a messy, make-or-break journey. And at [TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#), a founder who's been through the fire and two investors who've helped startups hit escape velocity will break down how to do it right.

On the [Builders Stage](#), Rajat Bhageria (Founder & CEO, Chef Robotics), Ann Bordetsky (Partner, NEA), and Murali Joshi (Partner, [ICONIQ](#)) join forces to unpack the most critical — and elusive — phase in a startup's life cycle. They'll dive into smart testing strategies, real-time iteration, and how to listen to your users without getting lost in the noise.

Don't miss this Disrupt 2025 conversation — and don't miss your chance to save up to \$675. Prices rise after tomorrow, August 6, at 11:59 p.m. PT.

[Register now.](#)



No more guessing — just growth

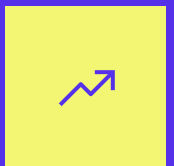
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- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion
- Lina Khan points to Figma IPO as vindication of M&A scrutiny

[Bhageria](#) brings the founder POV, having scaled [Chef Robotics](#) with AI-powered automation that's now transforming food production. [Bordetsky](#), with her background at Uber, Twitter, and now [NEA](#), knows how to spot the kind of scrappy ingenuity that leads to breakout success. [Joshi](#), fresh off a spot on the Forbes Midas Brink List, has helped drive over \$2.5 billion in investments in companies like Drata, 1Password, and Fivetran.

Together, they'll offer a rare behind-the-scenes look at what product-market fit *actually* looks like — and how to know when you've got it.

Building a hit product starts here

Whether you're still in prototype mode or trying to scale something that already has traction, this panel is for founders who are tired of guesswork and ready to build something customers can't live without.

Catch it on the [Builders Stage](#) at TechCrunch Disrupt 2025, happening October 27-29 at Moscone West in San Francisco. Join 10,000+ startup and VC leaders for the most important conversation in tech. [Grab your pass](#) before tomorrow ends to save up to \$675.

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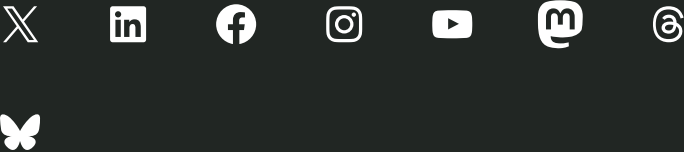
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